

INGENIOUS INCA

Machu Picchu is high up in the Andes Mountains. The air is thin here, and land is scarce. However, the Inca Empire is flourishing! A well-ordered society means that all goods are centrally organized and shared, and farmers have worked hard to find ways to grow as much food as possible.

Storehouse

Inca society was very organized. People had to work for the empire for part of the year and deliver what they produced to a local storehouse. Government officials then decided how the goods should be distributed.

People are bringing goods they have made to the storehouse.



Stone storehouses

Goods such as food, pottery, and metalwork were all kept inside the storehouses. To protect these valuable items, the storehouses had stone walls that still stand today, outliving the thatched roofs that kept the contents dry.



Archaeologists have found more than **2,000 Inca storehouses** in South America.

Ceremonial drink

The Inca made an alcoholic drink from maize called *chicha*. People drank it and offered it to the gods. It was transported in two-handled vases, which could be tied to someone's back by using a rope between the handles. It was among the many things that were kept in the storehouses.



Inca pottery was decorated with intricate patterns.